

Jim Gillespie

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SUMMARY

Senior Technical Writer with 20+ years of experience documenting complex software, hardware, and SaaS products. Proven track record collaborating with engineering, product, and UX teams in Agile environments to deliver accurate, structured documentation that accelerates product adoption and reduces support overhead. Consistently recognized for managing multiple projects in dynamic environments and delivering high-quality content under tight deadlines.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Independent Technical Writer | Austin, TX | Jan 2024–Present

- Conducted peer code reviews, providing actionable feedback on developer-facing docs.
- Completed standalone projects: built and deployed a portfolio site on GitHub; built, tested, and documented a functional mock REST API; and developed a workflow specification.
- Pursued coursework in API documentation, AI, cloud computing, and data analysis.

Senior Technical Writer | National Instruments | Austin, TX | Feb 2014–Dec 2023

- Updated hardware specifications and revamped the PXIe-4322 user manual, securing stakeholder approval and enabling \$1.5M in customer order fulfillment.
- Established a cross-team documentation review process spanning software development, hardware calibration, and compliance reviewers across global locations.
- Documented beta releases that drove customer sales and facilitated marketing of automotive test solutions, resulting in measurable reductions in support calls.
- Led monthly cross-functional meetings with Metrology, Calibration, and Technical Communication departments to prioritize projects, resolve issues, and ensure alignment.
- Authored API guides, hardware specifications, and reference content for complex test and measurement software and hardware platforms used in automotive, research, and government/defense applications.
- Migrated product documentation and build components from Perforce to Git, integrating with a developer-focused toolchain including Jira, Confluence, and Microsoft Azure DevOps.

Information Developer | HP TippingPoint (Contract) | Austin, TX | Jan 2013–Feb 2014

- Documented Next-Generation Firewall system, a complex enterprise security platform.
- Collaborated with HP's UX team to ensure efficient process flow and product usability; championed documentation concerns in Agile product scrums.
- Mentored new writers, training them on processes, tools, and best practices; led writers through training and certifications in HPE network security solutions.

Technical Writer | AMD (Contract) | Austin, TX | Nov 2011–Dec 2012

- Analyzed processor design and reference guides, organized content into book-level DITA maps, and coded XML for FrameMaker-to-DITA document conversions.
- Trained a team of 10 writers on using Oxygen Author, DITA conditional processing, SVN, and Alfresco CMS to create, edit, and curate documentation.

Technical Writer | Reddwerks | Austin, TX | Nov 2010–Nov 2011

- Provided hands-on user training to 20 warehouse workers on the supply chain picking system and wearable computer software features.
- Developed training manuals and user documentation for warehouse order fulfillment system.

Technical Writer | TippingPoint (Multiple Contracts) | Austin, TX | Mar 2010–Nov 2010

- Edited and updated user documentation for SaaS security management offerings.
- Collaborated with SMEs and legal department to create diagrams and process documentation contributing to the successful acquisition by HP Enterprises and subsequent system integration.

Technical Writer | National Instruments (Contract) | Austin, TX | Feb 2009–Mar 2010

- Evaluated and streamlined processes to convert FrameMaker source to HTML, XML, and DITA.
- Published specifications, pinout images, and connection diagrams to content management system for use by Marketing and Technical Communication departments.

Information Developer | IBM | Austin, TX | Jun 2000–Feb 2009

- Developed content for installation and administration guides, developer references, API guides, release notes, and online help for enterprise network security software.
- Adapted documentation processes for Agile software development, assimilating information from scrums and project wikis.
- Contributed to IBM Redbook, *e-Technology Center e-ESM 6.1 in a Shared Environment* (2006).

CORE COMPETENCIES

<i>Technical Writing</i>	Structured authoring, information architecture, DITA/XML, HTML, FrameMaker, Adobe Creative Suite, Oxygen Author, XMetaL
<i>Docs-as-Code</i>	Git/GitHub, Azure DevOps, Markdown, Confluence, Jira, CMS, version control
<i>API & Developer Docs</i>	OpenAPI/Swagger, REST API documentation, integration guides, developer documentation, release notes, SDK-related content
<i>Engineering Literacy</i>	JavaScript, Python, Java, C++, Git, Perforce, SVN, Visual Studio, VMware, API specifications
<i>Collaboration & Agile</i>	Cross-functional SME collaboration, Agile/Scrum methodology, global distributed team coordination, mentoring

EDUCATION

Master of Arts, English | Texas A&M University | College Station, TX
Bachelor of Science, English | Ball State University | Muncie, IN

CONTINUING EDUCATION & PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

UX Writing, Agile User Stories, Product Management Fundamentals, Art of Facilitation, Git & GitHub, API Documentation, REST APIs for Writers, JSON & XML, Agentic AI Fundamentals, Career Essentials in Generative AI, Prompt Engineering, AI Ethics, Problem Solving, Data Visualization, Assertive Communication

College coursework in C++, Java, and Object-Oriented Programming (Austin Community College)

RECENT PROJECTS

[Portfolio Site](#) (2025): Built and deployed a portfolio site using Docusaurus, Markdown, HTML, React, and Git, hosted on GitHub Pages.

[Instruments API](#) (2025): Built, tested, and documented a functional mock REST API using JSON, HTTP methods, Visual Studio Code, Postman, and JSON Server. Validated and tested CRUD operations, including GET, POST, PUT, PATCH, and DELETE. Managed project files and documentation using a Git-based, Docs-as-Code workflow. The JSON datastore manages a catalog of musical instruments. The project demonstrates API design, CRUD operations, and hands-on use of Postman for endpoint testing and documentation.

[AI-Assisted CRM Lead Follow-Up Workflow](#) (2026): Developed a workflow specification to document the design, API behavior, and AI governance requirements for an AI-assisted lead follow-up system within a Customer Relationship Management (CRM) platform.